

F. No.11019/07/2018-Sch.
Government of India
Ministry of Tribal Affairs
(Scholarship Division)

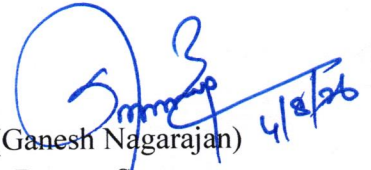
Kartavya Bhawan-1,
New Delhi-110001
Dated. 04.08.2026

NOTICE

Subject: Selection Criteria for preparation of the Provisional Merit List under the National Fellowship for Higher Education of Scheduled Tribe Students (NFST) for the Academic Year 2025–26 -reg.

The Ministry of Tribal Affairs published the Provisional Merit List of 750 candidates under the National Fellowship for Higher Education of Scheduled Tribe Students (NFST) for the academic year 2025–26 on 21.07.2026.

2. The Ministry is in receipt of several queries/representations through telephone calls, letters, e-mails etc. from the candidates belonging to Science stream to revise the merit list by normalizing the UGC-NET & CSIR NET scores. The Ministry has also been receiving representations from the selected candidates not to alter the already published selection list.
3. The matter has been examined and it is hereby clarified that the selection has been carried out in accordance with extant selection criteria. As per the extant selection criteria, the merit list has been prepared by giving 50% weightage to the marks obtained in the UGC-NET / CSIR-NET exam and 50% weightage to the marks secured in the Master's degree or a 4-year Bachelor's degree with Research (as per NEP 2020), on a scale of 100.
4. The concerns raised by the students are duly acknowledged and may be considered while revising the selection criteria/scheme guidelines in the future.


(Ganesh Nagarajan)
Deputy Secretary